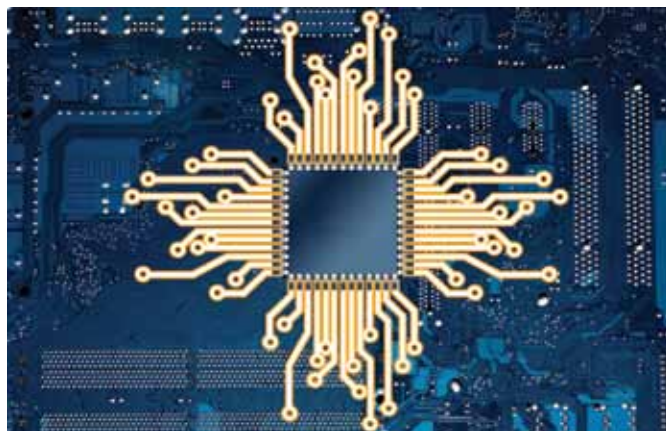


Government of India to update SPECS to ₹100 billion scheme

The government is set to enhance the Semiconductor Promotion and Enablement of Capital Goods (SPECS) scheme, aiming to transform it into a ₹100 billion initiative. The updated version will prioritise assistance to MSMEs and startups engaged in R&D within the semiconductor industry. The updated scheme may adopt a method where incentives are released as companies reach investment milestones or achieve specific targets. This change aims to bolster the ecosystem for the ATMP (assembly, testing, marking, and packaging) units being set up by companies like Micron, Tata Electronics, and Kaynes Corp.



Representational image

Maruti Suzuki to export lithium-ion cells worth ₹10 billion



Representational image

Maruti Suzuki plans to export lithium-ion cells worth ₹10 billion to establish a strong presence in the electric vehicle market. This move aligns with their focus on localisation and scalability. The parent-level joint venture with Suzuki is already producing India's first lithium-ion cells, primarily for hybrid vehicle batteries, and has started exporting them. Maruti Suzuki aims to establish a battery electric vehicle (BEV) plant with cell-level localisation as part of its broader strategy focusing on localisation and scale. TDS Lithium Ion Battery Gujarat Private Ltd, a collaboration between Toshiba, Denso, and Suzuki Motor Corp, is producing these battery packs, showcasing Maruti Suzuki's dedication to the evolving EV landscape.

PEOPLE (on the move)



Chandrakant Awate joins Electra EV as CTO



Electra EV, a powertrain solutions company backed by Ratan Tata, has appointed Chandrakant Awate, a veteran from Tata Motors, as its first Chief Technology Officer (CTO) to oversee engineering and technological developments and diversify offerings. Electra EV is actively strengthening its engineering and technology departments to expand the electric vehicle (EV) market.

Blackberry appoints John J. Giamatteo as new CEO



BlackBerry Limited has appointed John J. Giamatteo as its new CEO, and also as a member of its Board of Directors, following the retirement of ex-CEO John Chen on November 4. Richard (Dick) Lynch has served as the interim CEO since November 4, 2023, and will continue his role as Board Chair.